



Phishing Awareness Training

CodeAlpha Internship · Cybersecurity Fundamentals

 STAY SAFE
ONLINE

What is Phishing?

Phishing is a type of **cyber attack** where attackers disguise themselves as trusted sources — like your bank or a colleague — to trick you into revealing sensitive information.

The Goal

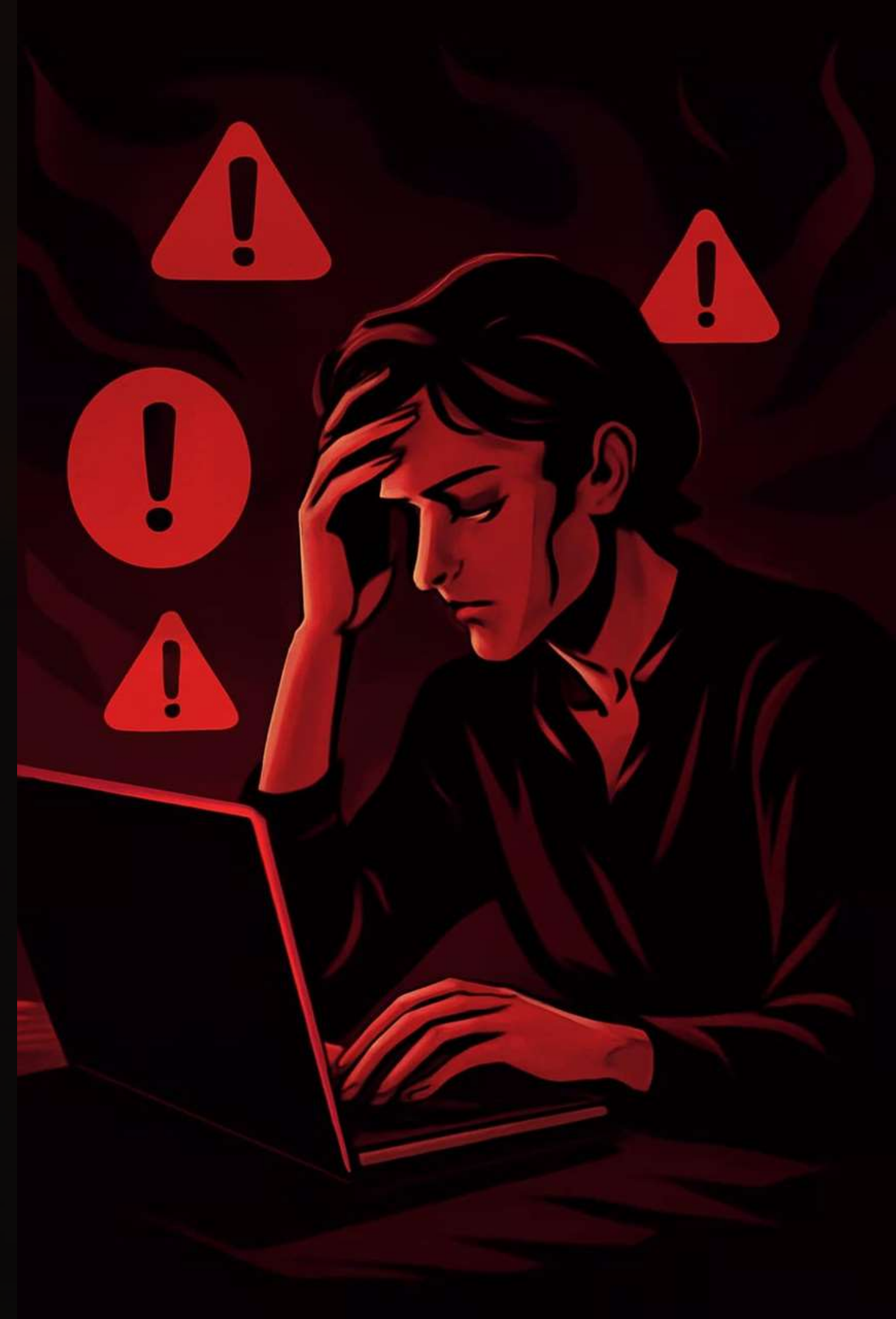
Steal passwords, bank details, and personal data

The Method

Fake emails, websites, and messages that look legitimate

The Risk

Identity theft, financial loss, and data breaches



Types of Phishing

Attackers use many channels. Knowing each type helps you spot them faster.



Email Phishing

Mass emails pretending to be from banks, retailers, or IT departments



Website Phishing

Fake websites that mimic real ones to capture your login credentials



SMS Phishing (Smishing)

Text messages with malicious links or urgent requests for personal info



Spear Phishing

Highly targeted attacks aimed at specific individuals or organisations



RED
FLAGS

Signs of a Phishing Attempt

→ **Unknown Sender**

The email address doesn't match the claimed organisation

→ **Urgent Language**

"Act now!" or "Your account will be suspended!" creates panic

→ **Suspicious Links**

Hover over links — the URL may not match the displayed text

→ **Spelling & Grammar Errors**

Professional organisations rarely send poorly written messages

→ **Fake Domains**

Look for subtle misspellings like "paypa1.com" instead of "paypal.com"

Real Phishing Example

Here is what a typical phishing message looks like. Can you spot the warning signs?

✖  **Subject:** URGENT: Your Bank Account Has Been Blocked!
From: security@bank-verify-update.com
Message: "Dear Customer, your account has been temporarily suspended due to suspicious activity. Please **click here** to verify your identity immediately or your account will be permanently closed."
Link: www.fake-bank-login.com/verify

▶ Fake Sender

Domain doesn't match the real bank

▶ Urgency Tactic

Pressure to act quickly without thinking

▶ Suspicious URL

Not the official bank website

How to Stay Safe



Don't Click Unknown Links

Always verify before clicking — hover to preview the URL first



Verify the Sender

Check the full email address, not just the display name



Use 2-Factor Authentication

Add an extra layer of security to your important accounts



Check URLs Carefully

Look for "https://" and the correct domain name



Key Takeaways

1 Phishing is dangerous – but preventable

Most attacks rely on human error.
Awareness is your strongest defence.

2 Always stay alert

Question unexpected messages, even from seemingly trusted sources.

3 Think before you click

A moment of caution can prevent a major security incident.

Quick Quiz – Test Yourself!

Let's see what you've learned. Discuss your answers with the group!

1

Question 1

You receive an email from "support@amazOn.com" saying your order is delayed. Real or fake?

2

Question 2

A text message from your "bank" asks you to click a link and confirm your PIN. What do you do?

3

Question 3

An email has perfect grammar but the sender's address is "hr@yourcompany-update.com". **Suspicious or safe?**



Answers: 1) Fake — misspelled domain. 2) Delete it — banks never ask for PINs via text. 3) Suspicious — domain doesn't match your company.

